

Timesheets *and invoicing*

Vantage Meridian pays monthly on a fixed day. Two things have to be in place for that to happen on time, and both of them are yours to control.

The first is a client-approved timesheet for every week of the month. The second, if you contract through your own company, is a valid tax invoice for the month. Miss either and the days concerned roll into the following month's run rather than being paid late in the current one. Employees do not invoice and are paid through payroll on the same cycle.

The cycle

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS
Each Friday, 5.00pm	You submit that week's timesheet in the system nominated for your assignment and send it for client approval.
Last business day of the work month	Own-company contractors email a valid tax invoice for the month to skylavelle@vantagemeridian.com.au . All approved timesheets for the month should be in by now.
Last business day of the following month	Payment is made. Salaries run on the same cycle.

Work performed in September 2026, for example, is invoiced by Wednesday 30 September 2026 and paid on Friday 30 October 2026. Every deadline and pay date for the year is set out in the Contractor Payment Schedule you received with your contract.

Timesheets

The timesheet is the record the client approves and it is what Vantage Meridian bills against, so it governs what you are paid regardless of what your invoice says. Where the two disagree, the approved timesheet wins and the invoice is queried.

- **Submit weekly, not monthly.** A month submitted in one block at the end sits with an approver who has forgotten the detail, and it is the most common cause of a late approval.
- **Record a full day as a full day.** Part days are recorded as halves where the Engagement Schedule allows them, and not rounded up.
- **Do not record unapproved additional hours.** If the client asks for work beyond the ordinary hours in your Engagement Schedule, get the approval in writing first and tell Sky.

- Public holidays are not worked days unless you actually worked and the client approved it. Employees are paid for public holidays under the National Employment Standards; own companies are not.
- Leave is recorded, not billed. Own companies simply do not bill days not worked. Employees apply for leave in advance through Vantage Meridian, and the client is told separately.
- Chase your own approvals. If a week is still unapproved by the following Wednesday, ask the approver directly and copy Sky.

Invoices

This section applies only if you contract through your own company. An invoice missing any of the items below is not a valid tax invoice, and it goes back to you rather than into the payment run.

REQUIRED ON THE INVOICE	DETAIL
Entity name	The company named in your Independent Contractor Agreement, not your personal name.
ABN	The ABN recorded on your New Starter Details Form.
Bill to	Lavelle Pty Ltd trading as Vantage Meridian, ABN 27 651 199 414.
Invoice number and date	Sequential and unique. Repeated numbers are queried.
Invoice period	The calendar month, stated in full – for example 1 to 30 September 2026.
Engagement reference	The Engagement Schedule number and the role. Add the client purchase order number where one has been issued.
Days worked	Matching the client-approved timesheets for the period, in days and half days.
Daily rate	Exactly as stated in your Engagement Schedule, exclusive of GST.
GST	Shown separately if you are registered. If you are not registered, do not charge it and say so on the invoice.
Total	The amount payable, including GST where it applies.
Payment details	The account recorded on your New Starter Details Form, and no other.

Worked example

A contractor registered for GST works 19 days in September 2026 at a daily rate of \$1,100 excluding GST. The invoice shows the following.

LINE	QUANTITY	AMOUNT
Delivery services, 1 to 30 September 2026, Engagement Schedule 004	19 days at \$1,100	\$20,900.00
GST	10%	\$2,090.00
Total payable		\$22,990.00

What delays a payment

Payment dates do not move, so anything that goes wrong pushes the money into the following month rather than a few days later. Five things account for nearly all of it.

1. A week left unapproved. Days not client-approved when payroll is processed carry into the next run, and the rest of the month is unaffected.
2. An invoice sent after the deadline. Late invoices are processed in the following run whatever the reason.
3. A rate that does not match the Engagement Schedule. The invoice is queried and held until it is corrected.
4. GST charged without registration, or omitted with it. Either makes the document invalid as a tax invoice.
5. An expired certificate of currency. Insurance has to remain current for the whole term, and lapsed cover suspends both the assignment and the payment.

Expenses

Expenses are payable only where the Engagement Schedule says so and where the client has approved them in advance. Travel to and from your usual work location is not an expense. Where expenses are approved, invoice them as separate lines with receipts attached, at cost and with no margin, and apply GST only where the underlying supply carried it.

If you are an employee

You do not invoice. Vantage Meridian pays your salary in arrears on the same monthly cycle, deducts PAYG withholding and pays superannuation at the legislated rate. Payslips are issued each pay run. Your timesheet obligation is identical, because the client still approves your time and Vantage Meridian still bills against it.

Payment queries

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